Smith & Wesson J-Frame Snubnose

Smith & Wesson • Airweight 642, 637, Model 36 & Bodyguard (.38 Special & .357 Mag)

Manufacturer:	Smith & Wesson	**Category:**	Revolvers
Action Type:	Double-Action-Only & DA/SA Concealed Carry Revolver	**Era / Service:**	American Concealed Carry Benchmark (1950–Present)
Calibers:	.38 Special (+P), .357 Magnum	**Covered Models:**	Model 642 Airweight (DAO Enclosed), Model 637 Chief's Special, Model 36 Classic (.38 Spl), Model 340 PD (.357 Mag Scandium)

KEY ARMORER TASKS & BENCH OPERATIONS

Core Procedures: Centennial Enclosed Hammer Disassembly • Apex J-Frame Duty Spring Kit • Barrel-Cylinder Gap Inspection • Firing Pin Bushing & Spring Service • Crane Screw Fitting

CRITICAL ARMORER TOLERANCES & SPECIFICATIONS

SPECIFICATION / CLEARANCE	ARMORER TOLERANCE & BENCH SPECIFICATION
BARREL LENGTH	1.875" standard snubnose barrel with fixed front ramp sight
FRAME MATERIAL	Aluminum alloy (Airweight) / Scandium alloy (AirLite) / Carbon or Stainless steel
TRIGGER PULL WEIGHT	11.5 to 13.0 lbs factory double-action; drops to 8.5–9.0 lbs with Apex Duty kit
FIRING PIN LOCATION	Modern J-frames feature frame-mounted spring-loaded firing pin rather than hammer-mounted hammer nose

IMMEDIATE ACTION & MALFUNCTION DIAGNOSTIC MATRIX

MALFUNCTION CONDITION	PROBABLE CAUSES	ARMORER BENCH REMEDY
Stoppage 1: Light Strikes on Hard Primer Defense Ammo **Hammer drops with normal snap, but primer fails to ignite on heavy-cup defense rounds**	• Installing ultra-light competition hammer springs in small-diameter J-frame coil strut. • Frame-mounted firing pin spring fouled with pocket lint causing firing pin drag.	**Gunsmith Action: Drive out firing pin retaining pin from frame. Extract firing pin and spring; clean tunnel with solvent. Install Apex extended length firing pin (increases protrusion by 0.008") and verify 100% primer ignition on CCI/Federal primers.**

CURATED BENCH VIDEO REFERENCES

PROCEDURE TITLE	INSTRUCTOR / CREATOR	TECHNICAL PROCEDURE SUMMARY
S&W; J-Frame 642 Disassembly, Apex Trigger Kit & Tuning	Apex Tactical Specialties	Step-by-step teardown of the S&W; J-frame Airweight, installing the extended firing pin, lighter rebound spring, and achieving a smooth 8.5 lb carry trigger.